HIM Education Server — Deployment Guide

HIM Education IT

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What You Need

- The USB drive (already prepared)
- New machine: x86-64 PC, 8 GB+ RAM, 100 GB+ SSD
- Ethernet cable connected to the internet (for downloading packages during install)
- Wireless card/adapter (for the Wi-Fi hotspot)

Step 1 — Boot from USB

1. Plug the USB into the new machine
2. Power on and press the boot menu key:
   - **Dell:** F12 | **HP:** F9 | **Lenovo:** F12 | **ASUS:** F8 | **Generic:** Esc / F11
3. Select the USB drive from the boot menu
4. At the Debian boot screen — press **Enter** (or wait 30 seconds, it auto-selects)

Step 2 — One Prompt: Set the Hostname

The installer will ask for a **hostname** (machine name). Type it, e.g.:

```
HIM-011
```

Press **Enter**. That is the **only question**. Everything else is automatic.

Step 3 — Wait for Install (~15–25 min)

The installer will automatically:

- Partition and format the disk
- Install Debian 13 base system
- Create user `him` (password: `him-edu`)
- Install SSH server and required packages
- Set up `him-provision.service` to run on first boot

The machine will **reboot automatically** when done. **Remove the USB** when it powers off.

Step 4 — Wait for First-Boot Provisioning (~20–40 min)

After reboot, `provision.sh` runs automatically in the background. It installs:

- Docker, Kolibri, Tailscale
- NextCloud Docker stack (5 containers)
- NextCloud apps: Calendar, Notes, Office
- Wi-Fi hotspot, DHCP, firewall, captive portal
- All systemd services

Monitor progress over SSH once the machine is up:

```
ssh him@<machine-ip>
journalctl -fu him-provision.service
```

Step 5 — Verify Everything Is Running

```
# Check all services
systemctl status him-ap him-firewall him-webserver kolibri docker

# Check Docker containers
docker ps

# Check Kolibri
curl -s http://10.42.0.1:8080/ | head -5

# Check NextCloud
curl -s http://10.42.0.1:8081/ | head -5
```

Step 6 — Test with a Phone or Laptop

1. Connect to Wi-Fi: **him-edu** / password **1234567890**
2. Open any browser — the captive portal appears automatically
3. Tap **Kolibri** → learning platform loads
4. Tap **NextCloud** → file sharing loads

Step 7 — Change Default Passwords

```
# Linux user password
passwd him
```

NextCloud admin password:

Go to `http://10.42.0.1:8081` → log in as **admin / admin123** → top-right avatar → **Settings** → **Security** → Change password

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Step 8 — Authenticate Tailscale (Remote Access)

```
sudo tailscale up
# Follow the URL it prints to authenticate with your Tailscale account
```

Quick Reference

Service	URL	Default Credentials
Captive portal	`http://10.42.0.1/`	Just visit
Kolibri	`http://10.42.0.1:8080/`	admin / admin123
NextCloud	`http://10.42.0.1:8081/`	admin@example.com / changeme
Nginx Proxy Manager	`http://10.42.0.1:8181/`	him / him-edu
SSH	`ssh him@<ip>`	
Wi-Fi SSID	him-edu	1234567890

Troubleshooting

Wi-Fi hotspot not visible:

```
sudo systemctl restart him-ap
journalctl -u him-ap -n 30
```

NextCloud not loading:

```
docker ps          # check all 5 containers are Up
docker logs nextcloud --tail 20
```

Kolibri not loading:

```
sudo systemctl restart kolibri
sudo systemctl status kolibri
```

Provisioning failed or incomplete:

```
sudo bash /opt/him-edu/provision.sh   # safe to re-run
```

Check provisioning log:

```
cat /var/log/him-provision.log
```